

Chord Progressions in C major

Original practice realizations • 4/4 • Hold each chord for four counts • Fingering not prescribed

I - V - vi - IV

Compare a repeating loop with a more decisive return to I.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	C	C3 - E3 - G3
2	G	G3 - B3 - D4
3	Am	A3 - C4 - E4
4	F	F3 - A3 - C4

I - vi - IV - V

Try one chord per bar, then return to I after the final V.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	C	C3 - E3 - G3
2	Am	A3 - C4 - E4
3	F	F3 - A3 - C4
4	G	G3 - B3 - D4

I - IV - V - I

An original four-bar practice realization, with I in the final bar.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	C	C3 - E3 - G3
2	F	F3 - A3 - C4
3	G	G3 - B3 - D4
4	C	C3 - E3 - G3

Try a different effect

For a gentle effect, play slowly and sound notes in sequence. For a lighter effect, try even short pulses. Mood labels are subjective playing suggestions.

Sources: Puget Sound Music Theory, sections 9.4 and 9.7; Open Music Theory (triads).

Chord Progressions in E major

Original practice realizations • 4/4 • Hold each chord for four counts • Fingering not prescribed

I - V - vi - IV

Compare a repeating loop with a more decisive return to I.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	E	E3 - G#3 - B3
2	B	B3 - D#4 - F#4
3	C#m	C#3 - E3 - G#3
4	A	A3 - C#4 - E4

I - vi - IV - V

Try one chord per bar, then return to I after the final V.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	E	E3 - G#3 - B3
2	C#m	C#3 - E3 - G#3
3	A	A3 - C#4 - E4
4	B	B3 - D#4 - F#4

I - IV - V - I

An original four-bar practice realization, with I in the final bar.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	E	E3 - G#3 - B3
2	A	A3 - C#4 - E4
3	B	B3 - D#4 - F#4
4	E	E3 - G#3 - B3

Try a different effect

For a gentle effect, play slowly and sound notes in sequence. For a lighter effect, try even short pulses. Mood labels are subjective playing suggestions.

Sources: Puget Sound Music Theory, sections 9.4 and 9.7; Open Music Theory (triads).

Chord Progressions in A major

Original practice realizations • 4/4 • Hold each chord for four counts • Fingering not prescribed

I - V - vi - IV

Compare a repeating loop with a more decisive return to I.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	A	A3 - C#4 - E4
2	E	E3 - G#3 - B3
3	F#m	F#3 - A3 - C#4
4	D	D3 - F#3 - A3

I - vi - IV - V

Try one chord per bar, then return to I after the final V.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	A	A3 - C#4 - E4
2	F#m	F#3 - A3 - C#4
3	D	D3 - F#3 - A3
4	E	E3 - G#3 - B3

I - IV - V - I

An original four-bar practice realization, with I in the final bar.

Bar	Chord	Notes (low to high)
1	A	A3 - C#4 - E4
2	D	D3 - F#3 - A3
3	E	E3 - G#3 - B3
4	A	A3 - C#4 - E4

Try a different effect

For a gentle effect, play slowly and sound notes in sequence. For a lighter effect, try even short pulses. Mood labels are subjective playing suggestions.

Sources: Puget Sound Music Theory, sections 9.4 and 9.7; Open Music Theory (triads).